

Kyungtae Lee

CONTACT INFORMATION

Ph.D. Economics
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, City University of New York, Graduate Center	Present
M.S. Economics, University of Wisconsin, Madison	2019
B.A. Economics, The Pennsylvania State University, University Park	2016
B.A. Mathematics, The Pennsylvania State University, University Park	2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Econometrics, Development Economics, Energy Economics, Environmental Economics

TEACHING FIELD

Intro Statistics, Econometrics, Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Financial Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

From One LATE to Another: Machine Learning and the External Validity of IV Estimates (with *Alexander Kwon*)

We examine when a LATE estimated in one population predicts the LATE in another. We decompose the prediction error of 2SLS with interacted fixed effects into an in-sample estimand error and two external terms tied to slope error and nonlinear treatment effects. We show that Double/Debiased Machine Learning improves prediction when the nuisance functions are misspecified, but its performance under nonlinear treatment effects depends on the final-stage model.

PUBLISHED

External Validity in an Instrumental Variable Setting (with <i>Alexander Kwon</i>)	Evaluation Review (2025)
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We studied the external validity of instrumental variable estimation. The key assumption we impose for external validity is conditional external unconfoundedness among compliers, which means that the treatment effect and target selection are independent among compliers conditional on covariates. Using a case study on solid-fuel use and women's cooking time across six countries, we found no violations of this assumption in Ethiopia, Honduras, Kenya, and Zambia; identified limited external validity in Cambodia and Nepal.

Geographical Factors Influencing Household Cookstove Choices in Nepal (with <i>Alexander Kwon</i>)	Social Sciences & Humanities Open (2025)
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We employ a logit model to analyze the factors, especially geographical characteristics, influencing households' choices regarding LPG stove adoption and generate slope and elevation data. We find that the estimates of the average slope are robust and statistically significant, but those for the average elevation are sensitive to model specifications and smaller compared to the slope. We find that the Kathmandu region is important in the analysis, and slope and elevation have nonlinear effects. Additionally, we show that geographical factors are similarly important across different household expenditure quintile groups, except for the lowest

WORKING PAPER	Clean Energy Access and Home Production Improvement: Labor Supply and Gender Difference (Top 4 Finalist for the Best Student Paper Award for 2025 USAEE Conference)	
	<i>The study examines the impact of adopting a clean energy cookstove on the intensive and extensive margin of labor supply, addressing the endogeneity issue. Using nationally representative data from Nepal, I found that adopting clean stoves increases men’s labor participation and workdays, while reducing women’s. Men worked more hours with clean stoves, whereas women’s hours were negative but did not change significantly after adopting clean cookstoves.</i>	
WORK IN PROGRESS	Carbon Pricing and Heterogeneous Abatement Responses: Evidence from Seven U.S. Cities (with <i>Jun Yoo</i>)	
	The Role of Accessibility in the Adoption of Clean Energy Stoves (with <i>Nadia Doytch</i>)	
CONFERENCE PRESENTATION	<i>From One LATE to Another: Machine Learning and the External Validity of IV Estimates</i>	
	- 2027 ASSA Conference (Poster)	
	- 2026 Africa Meeting of the Econometric Society	
	- 2026 ASSA Conference (Poster)	
	<i>Clean Energy Access and Home Production Improvement: Labor Supply and Gender Difference</i>	
	- IAEE session at 2026 ASSA Conference	
	- 2025 USAEE/IAEE North American Conference	
	<i>External Validity in an Instrumental Variable Setting</i>	
	- 2025 ASSA Conference (Lightning Session)	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Brooklyn College	
	Adjunct Instructor, Econometrics (Graduate Course)	Fall 2026
	Adjunct Instructor, Intro Econometrics	Fall 2026
	Adjunct Instructor, Financial Economics	Spring 2026
	<i>Average evaluation: 4.14/5.00</i>	
	Adjunct Instructor, Intro Business Statistics	Spring 2026
	<i>Average evaluation: 4.28/5.00</i>	
	Baruch College	
	Adjunct Instructor, Introduction to Microeconomics	Spring 2025–Fall 2026
	<i>Average evaluation: 4.02/5.00 (Spring 2026); 3.94/5.00 (Fall 2025); 3.91/5.00 (Spring 2025)</i>	
	<i>Class size: 75–85 students</i>	
	The City College of New York	
	Adjunct Instructor, Principles of Macroeconomics	Summer 2026
	Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics	Fall 2025
	<i>Average evaluation: 4.10/5.00</i>	

	Adjunct Instructor, Principles of Statistics	Spring 2025
	<i>Average evaluation: 5.00/5.00</i>	
	Adjunct Instructor, Intermediate Macroeconomics	Spring 2022 – Spring 2023; Summer 2025
	<i>Average evaluation: 3.85/5.00</i>	
	The Graduate Center	
	Teaching Assistant, Math for Economist (Econ Ph.D. program)	Fall 2022
	Hunter College	
	Instructor, Math Camp (Econ Master's program)	Summer 2022
	New York University	
	Teaching Assistant, Mathematics for Economists (Master's Program)	Fall 2021
	<i>Average evaluation: 4.21/5.00</i>	
TEACHING RESOURCES	Interactive Economics Teaching Platform	2026 – Present
	Developed a platform for my microeconomics and econometrics courses, used for interactive lessons, attendance, and live quizzes.	
WORK EXPERIENCE	Short-term Consultant, The World Bank, Washington DC	Sept 2023 - Dec 2024
	- Analyzed electricity demand, affordability, and access patterns using household data.	
	- Supported cross-country comparisons of energy demand and access conditions to inform energy policy and market assessments.	
	- Designed and refined household survey instruments to support data collection on energy demand and affordability.	
SCHOLARSHIP AND AWARD	Connect New York Fellowship, Early Research Initiative, CUNY Graduate Center	2026
	Dennis J. O'Brien USAEE Best Student Paper Finalist Award	2025
	Tuition Fellowship, CUNY Graduate Center	2019 - 2024
	Sallie Mae Awards, CUNY Graduate Center	2021
TECHNICAL SKILLS	STATA, R, Python, Julia, MATLAB, Git, SQL, Latex	
LANGUAGES	English(Fluent), Korean(Native)	
REFERENCES	Wim P.M. Vijverberg (Advisor) <i>Professor of Economics</i> Graduate Center City University of New York wvijverberg@gc.cuny.edu	Nadia Doytch <i>Professor of Economics</i> Brooklyn College City University of New York ndoytch@brooklyn.cuny.edu
	Jonathan H. Conning <i>Associate Professor of Economics</i> Hunter College City University of New York jconning@hunter.cuny.edu	
	(Updated: September 2026)	